EXECUTIVE MARKET MAP · CONFIDENTIAL

Do not sell governance software. Operate governed agents.

Agent governance is being bundled into the platforms customers already own. The durable opening for HDS is a productized managed service for regulated, asset-heavy agent fleets.

AUDIENCE	DATE	DECISION
HDS leadership	July 3, 2026	Enter as managed service, not standalone software

POSITION

Governed Agent Operations: neutral, cross-runtime, regulator-grade operations for OT-adjacent industries

01 THE ANSWER UP FRONT

Enter the market, but avoid the software trap.

The control-plane fight is being won by hyperscalers and SaaS suites through bundling. HDS should unbundle HARC AMS into a named, priced managed service sold per agent under management.

WHERE NOT TO PLAY

Standalone governance license SKU competing with Microsoft, ServiceNow, Salesforce, Google, and GRC incumbents.

WHERE TO PLAY

Cross-runtime operations for regulated, asset-heavy agent fleets touching plant, grid, maintenance, and safety workflows.

HOW TO TEST

Sell paid pilots in 90 days at pricing that implies at least **$150K ARR** per account.

02 FIVE CLUSTERS

The map is crowded, but only one lane fits HDS.

Platform control planes

Microsoft, ServiceNow, Salesforce, Google, and Boomi are making governance a suite feature pulled toward zero.

GRC software

Credo AI, Holistic AI, IBM, OneTrust, Collibra, and ModelOp split a small standalone software pool.

Observability and eval

Arize, Galileo, LangSmith, Langfuse, Fiddler, Braintrust, Maxim, AgentOps, and Datadog fight a developer-led PLG market.

Security and identity

AI TRiSM is the highest-budget lane, but buyers are CISOs and category power is consolidating fast.

Fellow SIs

Accenture, Infosys, Deloitte, and Cognizant use agent platforms as services pull-through, not standalone software.

03 PLATFORM GRAVITY WELLS

Governance is being bundled toward zero.

The largest vendors are not maximizing governance license revenue. They are using governance to make their agent runtime, workflow layer, and suite renewal harder to displace.

$15

Agent 365 monthly user price cited in the brief

$99

Bundled M365 E7 price cited for unlimited agents

$0.10

Agentforce action-style pricing reference

Zero

Direction of travel when governance is packaged into the control plane

IMPLICATION

Governance is a platform attachment, not a clean standalone product category.

RISK

A standalone HDS software SKU will look like duplicate spend to suite customers.

RESPONSE

Sell operational accountability the platforms do not want to staff.

04 MONEY VS. NOISE

The noise is software. The money is operations.

$492M	15–20	$13.8B	$10B+
Standalone governance platform spend cited for 2026	Governance software vendors splitting the small software pool	AI TRiSM market estimate cited for 2030	Agentic services market context around deployment and operations

AVOID

A governance software SKU where platform vendors bundle comparable capability.

WATCH

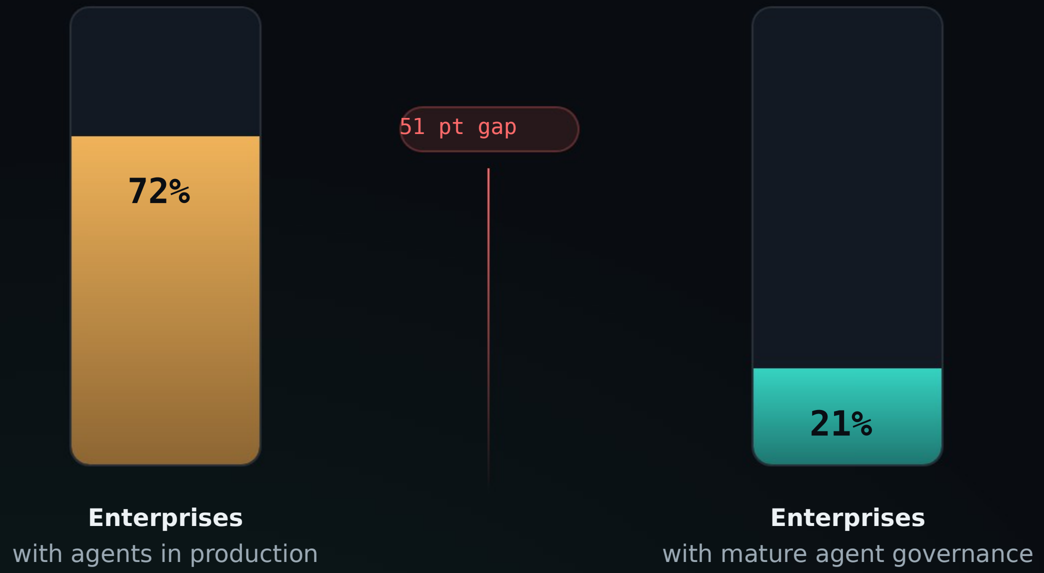
Security and identity budgets, but partner rather than fight category leaders.

ENTER

The execution gap: run the governed agent fleet after tools are bought.

05 EXECUTION GAP

Enterprise adoption is ahead of governance maturity.



That gap is not solved by another dashboard. It requires runbooks, human escalation, runtime monitoring, incident response, evidence packs, and ownership.

Those are operations problems. Operations is where HDS has permission to win.

06 WHITESPACE

Own cross-runtime governance where agents touch physical operations.

PLATFORM CONTROL PLANES

Govern the suite and the dashboard

Agent 365 · AI Control Tower · Agentforce · Gemini Enterprise · Agentstudio

PLANT, GRID, MAINTENANCE, SAFETY, REGULATED EVIDENCE

HDS GOVERNED AGENT OPERATIONS

Run the fleet across runtime and regulator boundaries

MES · SCADA · historians · work orders · maintenance agents · compliance packs

The wedge is neutrality plus operations: govern and run every agent fleet to the standard of the buyer's regulator.

07 OFFER DESIGN

Package HARC AMS as Governed Agent Operations.

UNIT

$/agent-under-management/month, not a software seat

CORE PROMISE

24/7 governed operations across Copilot Studio, Agentspace, Lyzr, Ema, and client runtimes

IP LAYER

Vertical packs: NERC CIP, IEC 62443, FDA 21 CFR Part 11, aviation

WHY IT FITS HDS

The economics look recurring and software-like, but delivery runs through an operating model HDS already understands.

WHAT TO AVOID

Do not create a license SKU that enters procurement bake-offs against bundled Microsoft or ServiceNow governance.

08 BUYER SHIFT

Sell to the risk owner, not only the delivery sponsor.

CIO / platform owner	SUITE PULL	Already owns Microsoft, ServiceNow, Salesforce, Google, or Boomi. Default instinct is to turn on the module.
CISO / CRO	RISK PULL	Owns incident exposure, identity risk, regulated workflows, and evidence expectations when agents take action.
Plant / ops leader	RUNTIME PULL	Needs governed automation in maintenance, grid ops, production, and safety-critical processes.

The service should be sold with a second buying center: CISO, CRO, and operations leaders who do not trust a suite checkbox to cover regulated runtime exposure.

09 STRONGEST COUNTERARGUMENT

The neutral-control-plane story may already be gone.

ServiceNow claims cross-system

AI Control Tower now positions itself as governance for agents across any system.

Microsoft partnership matters

Agent 365 integration weakens the outsider-neutrality argument before HDS can own it.

Customers already own it

Governance as a suite feature can make third-party spend look duplicative.

SI software risk is real

Product roadmaps starve when services utilization pressure returns.

The standalone market size signal argues against building another governance product.

10 CHEAPEST EXPERIMENT

Do not build first. Try to sell it.

DURATION

SAMPLE

10 accounts: five current HARC clients, five cold CISO or compliance buyers

PACK

Start with NERC CIP for utilities, then expand only after paid signal

PASS

At least **3** signed paid pilots at pricing that implies **$150K ARR** each, with one buyer outside the existing delivery sponsor.

FAIL

Zero takers at real pricing. Keep AMS as engagement glue and invest in security or identity partnerships instead.

11 DECISION RULE

The market will tell us if this is IP or collateral.

If three paid pilots do not close in 90 days at a real price —

the correct conclusion is not “build more product.” It is that HARC AMS works best as pull-through collateral inside services engagements.

The discipline: no standalone productization spend until buyers prove they will pay for governance operations separately from people.

12 EVIDENCE BASE

Claims are anchored to the supplied market brief.

Gartner AI governance platform market estimate	ServiceNow AI Control Tower expansion and Microsoft integration
Agent 365 licensing and pricing analysis	Credo AI, OneTrust, and AI governance vendor pricing references
LLM observability vendor and market comparisons	AI TRiSM market estimate and cybersecurity M&A signals
HFS Agentic Services model and SI positioning	Deloitte and Agentic AI Institute governance-gap research